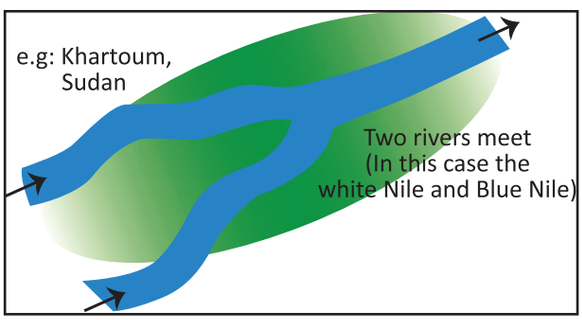


the point where the huge Notre Dame Cathedral is built.

10. The confluence of two rivers

Just as two valleys, or roads, make a nodal point for settlement growth, so do two rivers joining. One such example is found in Khartoum in Sudan, where the Blue and the White Nile meet. In India, Allahabad is located at the confluence of River Ganga and Yamuna and Bhavani (Tamil Nadu) is at the confluence of River Cauvery and Bhavani.



Situation

The situation of a settlement is the description of the settlement in relation to the other settlements and physical features around it. The situation of a settlement is the most important in determining whether it grows to become a large city or stays as a small town or village.

In the UK, Birmingham is an example of a city with excellent situation. It is located central to the country, with excellent links by road to the North and South to London.



As cities begin to fulfill different functions their importance can increase or decrease. Their situation plays an important part in deciding which of these functions will occur.

It refers to the location of the actual settlement. The initial choice of a site for a settlement depends on its meeting certain daily needs such as water supply, availability of potential farmland, building materials and fuels etc.

Settlements can broadly be divided into two types – rural and urban. Let us know some differences between rural and urban areas in general.

i. The major difference between rural and urban areas is the function. Rural areas have predominantly primary activities such as agriculture, whereas urban areas have domination of secondary and tertiary activities such as manufacturing industries and service sectors.

ii. Generally the rural areas have low density of population than urban areas.

iii. Urban settlements are defined by their advanced civic amenities, opportunities for education, and facilities for transport, business and social interaction and overall better standard of living whereas rural areas lack of such amenities.

iv. Rural areas do not have pollution or traffic problems that beset regular urban areas.

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